Arch mirror benchmark: Copenhagen

23 October 2026

Recommendation

Osbeck first, dotsrc second, Lysator third is the preferred general-purpose order. Osbeck led database downloads and had lower observed mean package completion time and variability. Your original list already started with Osbeck. For median throughput of large packages, dotsrc is the nominal leader.

Measurements and results

Of **154 European HTTPS mirrors** screened, 144 passed; all 18 finalists passed three shuffled repeat rounds. Downloads were serial; elapsed time included connection setup. The table uses **9 fresh rounds per mirror** of one 86.17 MiB Firefox package. All 27 payloads had the same SHA256.

Mirror	Median MiB/s	Mean ± SD MiB/s	Mean time (s)
Osbeck	77.17	78.33 ± 8.61	1.112
dotsrc	88.44	77.15 ± 16.24	1.169
Lysator	67.74	70.24 ± 6.26	1.234

MiB/s uses binary megabytes. SD is the sample standard deviation across within-session transfers. Database median rates were **Osbeck 55.58, dotsrc 37.79, Lysator 36.68 MiB/s** (three rounds each).

Dotsrc's median package throughput was **14.6% higher** than Osbeck's, saving 0.142 seconds at the median. It won 6 of 9 round comparisons. However, its slower transfers made its **mean completion time 5.1% longer**, which supports retaining Osbeck first when balancing speed and consistency.

Interpretation

These descriptive results cover one host, path and day. Repeated transfers are not independent days; no significance or confidence claims are made. Only the database top three received the package check. Other times of day and pacman's parallel downloads were not tested. No lasting winner or whole-upgrade speedup is established; no system mirrorlist was changed.

Evidence: detailed benchmark and saved measurements.